

PAULDING COUNTY HISTORY MUSEUM NEWSLETTER

November 2025

Editor – Judy Wells



Elizabeth Miller, Festival of Trees chairman, says she just loves decorating for Christmas! She and her husband Mike have spent countless hours decorating the museum.

Paulding County History Museum beginning to ‘Sparkle & Shine’

Our museum’s largest fundraiser of the year, The Festival of Trees, is just around the corner! Since September 30, when the FFA students from Staci Miller’s class brought nearly 80 Christmas trees in from the shed, we have been planning, organizing, and getting ready for the Festival. The theme for this year’s festivities is “Sparkle &

Shine.” Elizabeth Miller will again be the Festival chairman. Garland has been hung, trees have been decorated by our dedicated volunteers as well as by organizations, groups and clubs from around the county. We have planned menus, musical entertainment and even a few surprises for our Festival-goers!

A new feature this year will be Columbia Rose, a young guitarist and singer from Payne. She will perform on **Friday evening, Nov. 14** at 7:30 p.m. following the spaghetti dinner, which will be prepared by the Paulding Area Chamber of Commerce. The museum will be open on Friday from 4-8 p.m.

Saturday, Nov. 15 is Kids’ Day! We will be open 10 a.m.-8 p.m. Santa will visit from 10 a.m. until noon and Chris Bercaw will be making balloon animals for the kids throughout the afternoon. A lunch will be served from 11 a.m.-1 p.m. and will be hot dogs, burgers, mac-n-cheese. The meal will be prepared by the museum volunteers. Supper that evening, served from 5-7 p.m., will be a Baked Potato Bar. Our volunteers will also prepare that meal.

Sunday, Nov. 16 we will be open from 11 a.m.-4 p.m., with brunch served from 11-1. At 2:00, a new group to the msueum will provide the entertainment. Second Street Strings, a dulcimer group from Defiance, will perform.

Monday, Nov. 17, our hours will be 4-8 p.m. A Turkey Tetrazzini casserole dinner will be served from 5-7 p.m., prepared by the First Presbyterian Church Women.

Tuesday, Nov. 18 is Senior Day. Hours are 10 a.m.-8 p.m. We will be serving lunch to senior citizens from local nursing homes, BY INVITATION ONLY. Ellie Krynock will provide piano music during the luncheon. At 4 p.m., the Paulding High School Jazz Band will provide the entertainment. And from 5-7, a Baked Pasta dinner will be prepared and served by the Friends of the Paulding Parks.

Wednesday, Nov. 19 our hours are 4-8 p.m. The Paulding County Senior Center will be serving a Baked Ziti dinner from 5-7. At 7, the St. Paul Lutheran Bell Choir will perform.

Thursday, Nov. 20 we will again be open from 4-8 p.m. with a Soup and Chili supper, prepared and served by the museum volunteers from 5-7. Live music will include the Wayne Trace

High School Band and Choir from 5-6 and the Antwerp Community Band from 7-8 p.m.

Friday, Nov. 21 our hours are 4-8 p.m. The Hot Chocolate Bar will be open the entire time and Jane's Heavenly Dessert Bar will serve yummy desserts of all kinds from 5-7. The Christmas carol sing-along begins at 6:30.

Saturday, Nov. 22 is the last day of this year's Festival. We will be open from 10 a.m.-4 p.m. and will – for the first time – be participating in the “Shop the Village” event, sponsored by the Paulding Area Chamber of Commerce. The Hot Chocolate Bar will again be open from 10 a.m.-2 p.m. Walking Tacos will be served from 11-1 for lunch, prepared by the museum volunteers. The bidding on the Silent Auction will close at 2 p.m. that day, and the drawing for the OSU Raffle will be held at 2 as well.

Each day of the event, we will have a photo booth, the Memory Tree, the Mouse Hunt, Vote for Your Favorite Tree, OSU Raffle, and the Silent Auction. You will also be able to shop for unique gifts at our Contry Store and to sign Christmas cards to be sent to US Service members. We hope to see you at the 2025 Festival of Trees!

From the President's Desk



As autumn slowly fades towards winter, the Paulding County History Museum is busy planning for one of our most beloved traditions – the annual Festival of Trees. The theme of this year's nine-day event is "Sparkle and Shine." Every year, the museum transforms into a wonderland of holiday cheer, with beautifully decorated trees, wreaths, and seasonal displays created by community members, organizations, and local businesses. This event not only brightens our season but also serves as our largest fundraiser of the year, helping us continue our mission of preserving and sharing Paulding County's rich history. We hope you will join us, participate, and invite friends and family to experience this festive occasion.

In addition to preparing for the Festival of Trees, we are making plans for some much-needed improvements to our museum's kitchen area. These updates are timely, as the Paulding County History Museum will soon have the honor of hosting the Ohio Local History

Alliance (OLHA) Region 1 meeting. This gathering will bring members of nearby historical societies and local historians from across the region to Paulding, and we want to ensure our facilities are welcoming and well-prepared to serve our guests.

This special meeting will also coincide with a moment of great pride for our society. One of our own members, Carol Razzo, will be recognized by the OLHA with the Ohio History Award for her outstanding book, *From the River's Edge: A 200-Year Look at Crane Township*. Her dedication to research and storytelling has given our community a lasting contribution and ensures that Crane Township's history will be remembered for generations to come.

As we look ahead to the coming months, I encourage you to stay engaged, volunteer when you are able, and share the good work of the Paulding County History Museum with others. Together, we can continue to "Preserve the Past for Future Generations."

Mel R. White, president

Descendant of museum founder visits Paulding

In July, the Paulding County History Museum welcomed Dr. Resend Dereck Ross and his wife Georgia, to Paulding. They had come to explore the museum and honor their family's ties to Paulding County.

Dr. Ross is a direct descendant of Dr. George Phillips, whose early contributions were instrumental in the creation of the museum. The Rosses' visit provided an opportunity to reflect on both the preservation of county history and the enduring role of local families in that effort.

While at the museum, the Rosses toured the exhibits showcasing the region's early settlement, cultural traditions, and the settlers who helped shape Paulding County's identity. Volunteers at the museum noted the significance of the visit, emphasizing how descendants of early contributors strengthen the museum's connection to the past.

"It's not often we have the privilege of welcoming direct descendants of those who played such an important role in our history," said Mel White, president of the historical society. "The Ross family's presence here underscores the

importance of remembering and sustaining the legacy entrusted to us."

While in the county, the Rosses also visited the Middle Creek Baptist Cemetery, where one of Dr. Ross's ancestors is buried. The visit provided a personal moment of reflection for Dr. Ross, connecting genealogical history with the objective of the museum and the artifacts displayed there.

Dr. Ross acknowledged the impact of his family's role in the county's history. "Walking through the museum and visiting the cemetery brought home the importance of the work that has been done to preserve these stories," he said. "It is a reminder of how the past continues to guide the present."

During their visit, Dr. and Mrs. Ross became life members of the museum, supporting its mission of "preserving the past for future generations."



Georgia and Dr. Resend Derek Ross.

Another Successful Truck Show



There were 75 trucks registered for this year's annual Truck Show, held Sept. 21. That's down from 124 last year. "But the forecasted rain kept some of our annual participants home this year, plus the absence of the Fall Festival didn't help. We did have the Grover Hill Lions Club here with their homemade ice cream, though!" said Cindy Kauser, one of the sponsors of the event.

Dick Abbott from Blanchard, Michigan won the award for the Farthest Traveled, with 203 miles. He brought his 1912 REO H one-ton truck. Dick and Lynn Lantz tied for the Oldest Truck award, but because Dick had won the award for Farthest Traveled the award went to Lynn. He brought his 1912 "Defiance" truck. Stan Miller of Paulding was the winner of the 50/50 drawing. His share was

\$262 but he gave it all back to the museum. Thanks Stan!

Mike Speiser "digs" history

At our General Meeting on Sept. 23, Mike Speiser was the guest speaker following the business meeting. For the past 42 years, Mike has been searching farm fields, old house sites, and river banks for hidden treasure in Paulding and nearby counties.

"I became fascinated with metal detecting when I was about ten years old," he says. "I started pursuing my hobby in my spare time every chance I got. But when I retired, it became more of a full-time passion."

He now uses several different types of detectors, depending on where he plans to search, as well as small trowels, shovels, and other pieces of equipment.

Mike enjoys showing his finds to other folks who enjoy metal detecting, as well as to civic groups and organizations. He says he plans to continue pursuing his hobby for as long as he is able. Thanks Mike, for bringing your treasures to the meeting!



Iris' Sour Dough Cookies

2 c. sugar

1 t. baking soda

2 t. baking powder

½ t. salt

1 c. butter

3 eggs

1 t. vanilla

5 c. flour

1 c. sour milk

Cream sugar, eggs, vanilla together. Sift together baking soda, salt, baking powder and flour. Alternate milk and flour mixture.

Put a pan of hot water in the oven, but not directly under the cookies. Bake at 350-degrees for 10 minutes for small cookies or 18 minutes for larger cookies. Dust with powdered sugar after baking.

To make 1 c. sour milk for baking, use 1 T. vinegar or lemon juice and enough milk to equal 1 cup. Stir and let stand for 5 minutes before using. This will give the right amount of acidity for the recipe.

This recipe is from Iris Gallagher's Bakery, located on the square in Paulding for many years. One of our volunteers

was given the recipe by Iris before she passed away. The volunteer has kept the recipe close to her heart ever since, but feels the Christmas season is a good time to share it with our readers.

Iris (Free) Gallagher died on Sept. 17, 2006 at the age of 99. She was buried in Zion Cemetery in Fulton County, Ohio. Her memorials were directed to the John Paulding Historical Society.



Join us at Jane's Heavenly Dessert Bar, Nov. 21, to sample some of these delicious cookies, as well as other sweet treats! Jane will be serving from 5-7 p.m.



Is Your Membership Current?

Being a member of the Paulding County History Museum shows that you care about our county’s history and that you want to help us preserve it for future generations.

Take a look at your mailing label on this newsletter. In the lower left hand corner is the year your membership expired.

Memberships run from January 1st to December 31st each year. To save postage, we do not send out statements for your dues. We trust that you will renew your membership each year.

By renewing your membership, supporting our fundraisers and making donations, you help to keep our doors open and admission to the museum free.

Individual memberships are \$20 per person. Family memberships (parents and children in the household under 18) are \$25. Youth (under 18; non-voting membership) is just \$3.00. Supporting memberships for business/professionals are \$150 and non-profits are \$75. Lifetime membership dues are \$150.

Thank you for renewing your membership in a timely manner! Mail checks to Paulding County History Museum; P.O. Box 93, Paulding, OH 45879.

Paulding County History Museum

2024-2025 Officers

President Mel White

V. Pres. Kim Sutton

Secretary Judy Wells

Treasurer Julie Anna Densmore

Asst. Treas. Patti Boundy

DIRECTORS (3-year term)

Blue Creek Patti Boundy

Brown Sue LaFountain

Emerald Jane Stouffer

Latty Roger Flint

Auglaize Angie Pollock

Crane Mike Bevis

Carryall Dan Wilder

Benton Dennis Sanderson

Harrison Gene Olwin

Jackson Guy Dasher

Paulding Elizabeth Miller

Washington John Pier

PAULDING COUNTY HISTORY MUSEUM

600 Fairground Drive

P.O. Box 93

Paulding, OH 45879

WE WANT TO HEAR FROM YOU!

Do you have an idea for an event, exhibit, or presentation topic?

Your input is appreciated!

Please email your idea to jphs45879@yahoo.com or talk to any

officer or director.

Or join us any Tuesday from 10 a.m.-4 p.m.